

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES · TUNISIA

TUNISIA

Offbeat, immersive & tailor-made — prepared for Trotting Soles

WHO WE ARE

Depart Travel Services is a licensed Tunisian Destination Management Company based on the island of Djerba. We are a fully tailor-made and FIT specialist: every journey is designed from scratch, route by route, host by host, around the traveller in front of us.

We run our own insured fleet and work with ONTT-certified, English-speaking tour leaders who know the Berber south, the oases and the crowd-free Roman heartland not as a script but as home ground. A 24/7 in-country support line stands behind every departure, and our small team answers as people, not call queues.

We are not a high-volume coach operator. We are the partner UK tour operators turn to when they want the *real* Tunisia delivered with the reliability of a licensed DMC and the intimacy of a local family.



WHY DEPART TRAVEL — FOR TROTGING SOLES

Sunita, Trotting Soles is built on offbeat, immersive, tailor-made travel for FIT clients who want a genuine connection with the places they visit. That is precisely the Tunisia we sell. Here is how we map to your brand.

- **Offbeat.** We lead with the Tunisia most operators skip: the troglodyte villages of Matmata and Tamezret, the hilltop ksour of Chenini and Douiret, the mountain oases of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès, and Roman cities you will often have to yourself.

- **Immersive.** Your travellers sleep in a restored troglodyte house at Tijma, eat in a Berber family home, sit around desert music and storytelling at a wild bivouac, and learn the wheel from Guellala potters — not photograph these things from a window.
- **Soft adventure.** Camel trek and wild bivouac in the Grand Erg Oriental, canyon and oasis walks in the mountains, and dedicated walking itineraries — graded gentle-to-moderate, never expedition-grade, exactly the register your FIT clients want.
- **Authentic local connection.** Around 95% of our accommodation and roughly 90% of meals are locally owned, with fair, direct pay to the artisans and hosts your clients meet. The money stays in the room.
- **Fully tailor-made / FIT.** Guaranteed from 2 passengers, private and bespoke as standard, no compulsory single supplement — designed for the independent traveller, not the fixed group.
- **Built for the UK market.** English-speaking certified leaders, ABTA-aligned animal-welfare standards (camel riding always optional), and CO₂e-per-night reporting that is eCollective-ready for your carbon accounting.



WHY TUNISIA — THE OFFBEAT NORTH AFRICA

Tunisia is the North African destination your clients have not yet been sold. It packs the Sahara, the Berber highlands, Mediterranean islands and some of the finest Roman ruins outside Italy into distances you can cross by road in a single relaxed trip — no domestic flights, no dawn transfers.

While the coast draws the package crowds, the interior stays quiet. At Dougga and Sbeitla your travellers can walk a Roman forum almost alone. In the south, the ksour, oases and dunes deliver the cinematic, lesser-known Tunisia that rewards the curious independent traveller — the offbeat heart of a country that is genuinely safe, warm and welcoming, and easy to reach from the UK.

For an operator actively developing North Africa, Tunisia is the standout: differentiated, deliverable, and ready for tailor-made FIT product now.



RECOMMENDED FOR TROTTING SOLES

Best matches for your offbeat, immersive, soft-adventure FIT clientele are listed first.

Tour	Days	Style	Why it fits Trotting Soles
Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map	8–9	Offbeat / soft adventure	The deep south — ksour, troglodytes, camel trek & wild bivouac — the most offbeat product we run.
Immersive Tunisia (FIT, bespoke)	9–10	Immersive / tailor-made	A made-for-you blend of oases, troglodyte stay, Djerba crafts and crowd-free Roman sites.
Flavours of Tunisia	7–8	Culinary immersion	Hands-on cooking, markets and family kitchens — authentic local connection through food.
Walking Tunisia	8	Soft adventure	Canyon, oasis and ksar walks graded gentle-to-moderate for active FIT travellers.
Roman Tunisia	8	Culture / crowd-free	Dougga, Sbeitla and Carthage with room to breathe, for culture-led clients.
Grand Tunisia Journey	12	Comprehensive	The full sweep, north to deep south, for first-time Tunisia clients wanting it all.
Highlights of Tunisia	8	Classic introduction	A balanced first taste — heritage, oases and a desert night.

Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map

Overview. Our most offbeat journey: a south-focused loop from Djerba through the ksour, troglodyte villages and mountain oases into the dunes of the Grand Erg Oriental, with a camel trek and a wild bivouac under the stars. Soft adventure with deep local immersion at every step.

Key Information

Duration	8–9 days
Style	Offbeat / soft adventure / immersive
Start / End	Djerba
Guaranteed from	2 passengers
Basis	Land-only, twin-share, private/tailor-made
Walking	Gentle to moderate; camel riding optional

Highlights

- Overnight in a restored troglodyte house at Tijma
- The ksour of the south — Ksar Hadada, Chenini, Douiret
- Camel trek and wild bivouac in the Grand Erg Oriental
- Mountain oases and canyons — Chebika, Tamerza, Midès
- Desert music and storytelling under the stars
- Djerba crafts — Guellala pottery and Djerbahood street art

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrival on Djerba

Arrive on the island of Djerba and meet your English-speaking certified leader. Settle into a locally owned island *dar*, walk the whitewashed lanes and ease into Tunisian time with a welcome dinner of island specialities.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Djerba Crafts & Djerbahood

A full immersive day on Djerba: throw a pot with the potters of Guellala, visit the ancient El Ghriba synagogue, and wander the open-air murals of Djerbahood, meeting the artists who keep the village alive.



Accommodation: Island dar (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch

Day 3: Into the Ksour — Ksar Hadada & Chenini

Cross to the mainland and climb into the hill country of the south. Explore the fortified granaries of Ksar Hadada and the dramatic hilltop village of Chenini, where Berber families still live among the ridgelines.



Accommodation: Restored troglodyte house, Tijma · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 4: Troglodyte Country — Matmata & Tamezret

Spend the day in the Berber highlands among the underground homes of Matmata and the stone village of Tamezret, sharing mint tea and conversation in a Berber family home before returning to your troglodyte guesthouse.



Accommodation: Restored troglodyte house, Tijma · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 5: Camel Trek & Wild Bivouac

Drive to the edge of the Grand Erg Oriental and trade wheels for camels (riding always optional — walk if you prefer). Trek into the dunes to a wild bivouac, where dinner is followed by desert music and storytelling under a vast sky.



Accommodation: Wild desert bivouac · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 6: Dunes & the Mountain Oases

Wake to sunrise over the sand, then journey to the mountain oases. Walk the palm-shaded canyons and waterfalls of Chebika and Tamerza, where springs cut through ochre cliffs.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 7: Midès Canyon & Oasis Life

A gentle walk along the rim of the spectacular Midès canyon, then time among the palmeries to slow down, swim and meet oasis growers tending the date palms.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 8: Return to Djerba

A scenic drive back toward the coast, with stops for the landscapes and villages along the way, returning to Djerba for a farewell dinner in a locally owned *dar*.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 9: Departure

A relaxed final morning on the island before your transfer to Djerba airport. (Day 9 is optional — the journey can be tailored to 8 days.)



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

Immersive Tunisia (FIT, offbeat)

Overview. A bespoke 9–10 day journey designed for the independent traveller who wants the offbeat Tunisia with room to linger: oases and a troglodyte stay in the south, Djerba's craft villages, and the great Roman cities of the interior visited when the coaches are not. Fully tailor-made and built to flex around your clients.

Key Information

Duration	9–10 days
Style	Immersive / offbeat / tailor-made FIT
Start / End	Tunis / Djerba (or reverse)
Guaranteed from	2 passengers
Basis	Land-only, twin-share, private/bespoke
Walking	Gentle; flexible pace

Highlights

- Crowd-free Roman Dougga and Sbeitla

- Overnight in a restored troglodyte house at Tijma
- Mountain oases of Chebika and Tamerza
- Guellala pottery and Djerbahood street art on Djerba
- A Berber family home and a desert camp night
- Built fully tailor-made around your travellers

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrive Tunis

Arrive in Tunis and transfer to a locally owned heritage *dar* in the medina. Meet your leader and settle in with a first walk through the souks and a welcome dinner.



Accommodation: Heritage *dar*, Tunis (locally owned) · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Crowd-Free Dougga

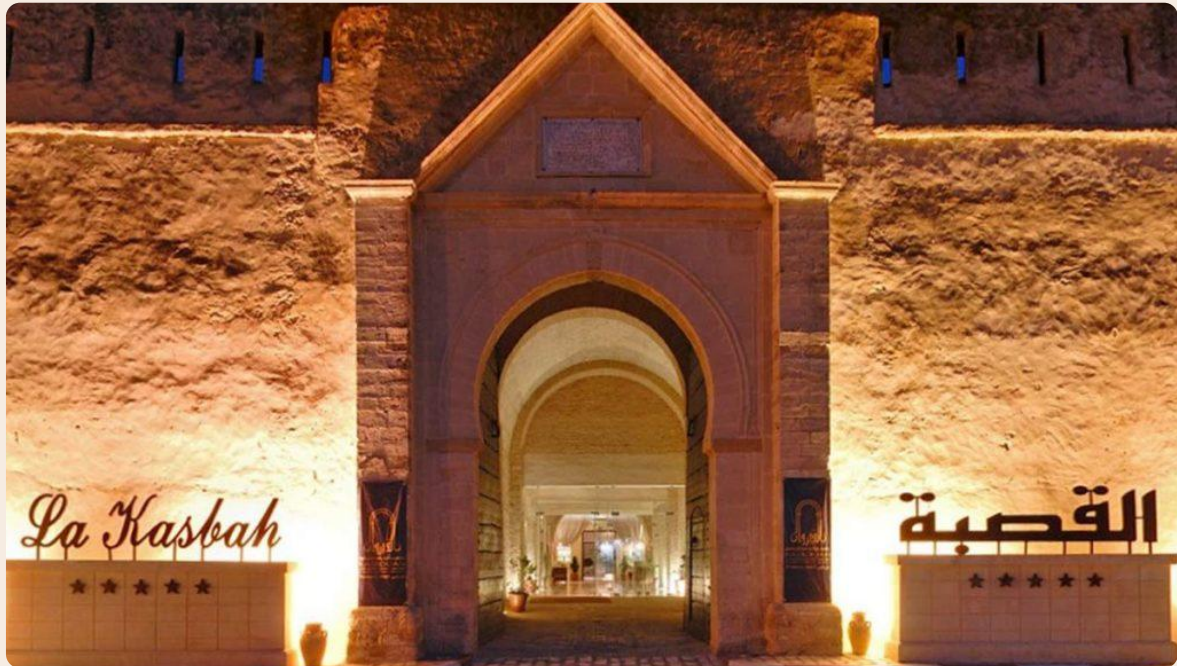
Drive into the green hills to Dougga, the best-preserved Roman town in North Africa, and walk its theatre, capitol and temples with space and time the coast can never offer.



Accommodation: Heritage *dar*, Tunis (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch

Day 3: Kairouan & the Road South

Head south to the holy city of Kairouan — its Great Mosque, kasbah and carpet workshops — meeting weavers at the loom before settling in for the night.



Accommodation: Boutique dar (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 4: Sbeitla — Roman Stones in the Steppe

Explore Sbeitla, where three honey-coloured Roman temples stand almost alone in the open steppe, then continue toward the mountain oases.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 5: Mountain Oases — Chebika & Tamerza

A gentle day among the palm-shaded canyons and waterfalls of Chebika and Tamerza, with time to walk, swim and meet the families who farm the springs.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 6: Desert Camp Night

Cross to the edge of the dunes for a night at a desert camp — an optional sunset camel ride, dinner under the stars and live desert music and storytelling around the fire.



Accommodation: Desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 7: Troglodyte Country & a Berber Home

Into the Berber highlands of Matmata and Tamezret to share mint tea and a home-cooked meal in a Berber family home, then overnight in a restored troglodyte house at Tijma.



Accommodation: Restored troglodyte house, Tijma · *Meals:* Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 8: Djerba — Crafts & Community

Cross to the island of Djerba: learn the wheel with the potters of Guellala, visit El Ghriba, and explore the open-air murals of Djerbahood.



Accommodation: Island dar (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 9: Djerba at Leisure

A flexible final full day — cycle the coast, browse the markets or simply slow down by the sea — closing with a farewell dinner of island specialities.



Accommodation: Island *dar* (locally owned) · *Meals:* Breakfast, Dinner

Day 10: Departure

A relaxed morning before your transfer to Djerba airport. (Day 10 is optional — the journey tailors easily to 9 days.)



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

RESPONSIBLE TRAVEL

Responsible travel is structural for us, not a badge.

- **Local ownership.** Around 95% of our accommodation and roughly 90% of meals are locally owned — heritage *dars*, oasis hotels, a desert camp and troglodyte guesthouses run by the families who host you.
- **Fair, direct pay.** Artisans, hosts and guides are paid directly and fairly, so the value of each journey stays in the community your clients visit.
- **Animal welfare.** ABTA-aligned standards apply throughout; camel riding is always optional, never compulsory.
- **Lower-impact operations.** Reusable water on every trip, our own efficiently routed fleet, and CO₂e-per-night reporting that is eCollective-ready for your carbon accounting.



PRICING

Illustrative only. The figures below are indicative EUR net, land-only, per person, twin-share. Final pricing depends on season, accommodation tier, group size and inclusions, and is confirmed in your costed proposal.

Tour	Days	Indicative net pp (EUR)
Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map	8–9	from ~€931–1,770
Immersive Tunisia (FIT, offbeat)	9–10	on application (bespoke)
Highlights / Roman / Walking / Flavours	7–8	from ~€931–1,770
Grand Tunisia Journey	12	from ~€1,158–2,952

All rates are land-only, twin-share net, with **no compulsory single supplement** and departures **guaranteed from 2 passengers**. We return a fully costed proposal within **72 hours** of your brief.

LET'S DESIGN YOUR TUNISIA

Sunita, let's build a Trotting Soles signature: the offbeat, immersive, soft-adventure Tunisia your FIT clients are looking for, delivered by a licensed local DMC.

Next steps

1. Send us a brief — dates, party size, pace and the experiences you want to lead with (we suggest starting with **Berber South & Sahara** and a **bespoke Immersive Tunisia**).
2. We return a fully costed, tailor-made proposal within 72 hours.
3. We refine together until it is exactly right, then confirm — guaranteed from 2 passengers, no single supplement.

Contact

- Email: direction@depart-travel-services.com
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- Web: <https://depart-travel-services.com/fr/>

🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.